Section 508 Accessibility Assessment and Remediation Report

Fictional Word, PDF and web sample findings; methods, scope, evidence and retest plan

Document ID	PSRO-A11Y-003	Revision	0.1
Owner	Demo Content Operations	Status	Illustrative draft

Scope note: The Public Services Resource Office (PSRO) is an invented organization. All assets, personas, metrics, evidence IDs, and review outcomes in this document are synthetic. No federal agency approved or used this procedure.

Legal and methodological basis

For covered federal ICT, the Revised Section 508 Standards incorporate WCAG 2.0 Levels A and AA for applicable electronic content. The ICT Testing Baseline for Electronic Documents version 1.0 (September 2024) is a reference testing baseline, not a complete step-by-step agency test methodology. DHS Trusted Tester is a defined methodology for web testing and has a certification program; this project does not claim certified Trusted Tester results.

Sample scope: the PSRO Word user guide, PDF print form, and a deliberately flawed prototype HTML page. These are synthetic artifacts, not federal production systems. A draft authoring inspection and repeatable static checks were performed; visual/assistive-technology evaluations are designated NOT EXECUTED where applicable.

Accessibility defect register

Finding	Sample / impact	Reference and proposed fix	Verification status
A11Y-01	Prototype input has no accessible name	WCAG 2.0 1.3.1 / 3.3.2 — add HTML label	Static source check: corrected markup verified
A11Y-02	Clickable div not keyboard operable	WCAG 2.0 2.1.1 — use native button	Static source check: button element verified
A11Y-03	Instructions rely on red vs green alone	WCAG 2.0 1.4.1 — text and icons/status words	Content review: revised copy present
A11Y-04	Word sample uses manually bolded text rather than real heading styles	WCAG 2.0 1.3.1 — Heading 1/2 styles	Word document structure inspection required
A11Y-05	PDF sample lacks confirmed reading-order/tag-tree evidence	Section 508 document baseline — inspect tags, sequence, links	Manual Acrobat/PAC-style audit NOT EXECUTED
A11Y-06	Resource results change after filtering without an announced result count	WCAG 2.0 4.1.3 is WCAG 2.1 supplemental, not 508 minimum; aria-live as enhancement	Static markup reviewed; screen reader test NOT EXECUTED

Test steps and evidence expectations

1. Record file name, version, reviewer, date, applicable baseline and software environment.

2. For Word: inspect built-in headings, table structure, meaningful hyperlink text, non-color-only communication, language setting, and alternative text for informative images. Run Word Accessibility Checker and manually verify exceptions.
3. For PDF: verify whether PDF is tagged, assess tag hierarchy, logical reading order, content artifacts, form labels, language, document title, and keyboard focus order using suitable PDF tools; preserve screenshots / machine output and manual reviewer observations.
4. For web: inspect semantic headings, landmark navigation, input labels, focus order, visible focus, keyboard-only operation, contrast and error messaging; follow an authorized DHS procedure if official Trusted Tester results are claimed.
5. Record exact reproduction steps, expected and actual result, impact, severity, source criterion, test environment, proposed fix and retest evidence.
6. Do not close a finding on a tool "pass" alone. Retest the user interaction and get approval from the designated accessibility authority.

Explicit limitation: The exported PDFs in this portfolio have not been shown to meet all Section 508/PDF accessibility requirements. They should not be submitted to a federal agency as conformant deliverables without qualified testing and remediation.

Prioritized remediation roadmap

Priority	Action	Owner	Acceptance evidence
P0	Block inaccessible mission-critical form from release	Product Owner	Approved accessible alternative and defect disposition
P1	Fix labels, focus and headings in sample HTML	Web Developer	Code diff plus keyboard manual test
P1	Create accessible Word source document	Technical Writer	Checker results plus human review
P1	Remediate exported PDF and verify tag/reading order	PDF Specialist	Detailed PDF assessment record
P2	Review content style and link descriptions	Editor	Editorial review log

Accessibility reviewer sign-off

Illustrative decision: OPEN / NOT CERTIFIED. This portfolio records candidate fixes, a test approach and a review log. A future real assessment would need a designated tester, specific test tools and versions, actual observed outcomes, and the organization's acceptance procedures.

Reference basis and limitations

Primary reference: https://www.section508.gov/test/documents/ . Additional source links and applicability are documented in review/REFERENCE_REGISTER.md.

Compliance note: Section 508 applies to covered federal ICT; WCAG 2.0 A/AA is incorporated by reference in the revised standards. WCAG 2.2 is noted only as complementary guidance. Automated checks do not establish full conformance. DHS Trusted Tester certification is not claimed.

Updated legal applicability and method-selection notes

Standards review: November 3, 2026. These additional controls and verification expectations are recommendations or conditional obligations for real federal systems; they are not evidence that the fictional PSRO system is approved, tested or compliant.

Section 508 applicability

The Revised Section 508 Standards apply to covered federal ICT; E205.2 covers public-facing electronic content and E205.3 specifies covered non-public official agency communications, including certain training material, forms and intranet pages. E205.4 incorporates WCAG 2.0 Level A/AA, subject to stated non-web document exceptions.

Separate test tracks

Use a documented agency-prescribed method for Word, Excel, PDF and HTML/web pages. The Interagency ICT Testing Baseline for Electronic Documents v1.0 is for non-web documents and is not the DHS Trusted Tester web procedure. Document whether a failure was observed, inferred from code review, or remains untested.

Test evidence required for real conclusion

Record exact file/version, application and browser, assistive-technology combination where used, tool/version, test steps, observed outcome, SC or baseline test ID, screenshot or audit output, reviewer, remedial change and retest. Findings remain OPEN until evidence supports closure.

PDF/Excel special cases

PDF exports require an accessibility review of tags, structure, headings, correct reading order, tables, links, figures and document language. Excel requires review of workbook structure, sheet names, table headers, navigation, alternative descriptions and avoiding color-only communication. No file in this project is certified 508 conformant.

Beyond the legal minimum

WCAG 2.2 / ISO/IEC 40500:2025 is a current supplemental standard for accessible web design; it does not replace the federal WCAG 2.0 A/AA incorporation by itself. No certified DHS Trusted Tester evaluation was carried out.

Primary references for this addendum

- Section 508 Revised Standards: https://www.access-board.gov/ict/
- Electronic Document Testing Baseline: https://ictbaseline.access-board.gov/document-baselines/
- Federal Document Testing: https://www.section508.gov/test/documents/
- PDF Authoring: https://www.section508.gov/create/pdfs/
- Word Authoring: https://www.section508.gov/create/documents/
- Excel Authoring: https://www.section508.gov/create/spreadsheets/
- DHS Trusted Tester: https://www.section508.gov/test/trusted-tester/
- WCAG 2.2: https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG22/